density birds in that desert or forest individually.
Reason(R): Ecological niche causes higher species density at the edge which is unique compared to the individual ecosystems.
Answer using the codes given below:
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true, and R is not correct explanation of A
(c) Only A is true, and B is not true
(d) Neither A nor B is true.

37. Ecological succession is characterised by:
1. Increased productivity
2. Decreased complexity of food webs
3. Decreased diversity of organisms
4. Shift of nutrients from the reservoirs Choose the incorrect combination using the codes given below:
(a) 2 and 3 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1, 2, 3 and 4
(d) 2, 3 and 4 only

38. Which of the following species can be pioneer species in ecological succession on land?
(a) Grasses, algae, fungi and mosses
(b) Mosses, algae, viruses, lichen, phytoplankton
(c) Lichen, mosses
(d) Algae, bacteria, mosses, viruses, grasses

39. *Assertion(A):* Rate of secondary succession is usually relatively faster than primary succession in ecological succession at a site.
Reason(R): Secondary succession starts on a well-developed soil already formed at the site which lacks primary succession.
Answer using the codes given below:
(a) Both A and R are true, and R is correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true, and R is not correct explanation of A
(c) Only A is true, and B is not true
(d) Neither A nor B is true.

40. If forests were to replace grasslands in ecological succession, which of the following conditions are necessary.
1. Water availability for survival of trees
2. Less occurrence of fires